WILLY (WEI-LI) CHEN

Old Botany Rm 5, Michigan State University | East Lansing, MI
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EDUCATION

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI *August 2022 – Present*
Doctor of Philosophy - Economics
- ICER NASA Open Scholarship Fellow *Fall 2026*
- Summer Research Fellowship *Summer 2026*
- Peter Schmidt [Outstanding First-Year Student] Award *Summer 2023*

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL *October 2019 – August 2020*
Master of Arts in Social Sciences—Economics
- Phoenix Research Award
- Director's Scholarship

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH *August 2015 – May 2019*
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics—Theoretical
Bachelor of Science in Economics—Summa Cum Laude with Research Distinction

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

- US Sailing Small Boat Sailing Level 1 Instructor
- Data Analytics and Econometrics: Stata, R, Python, PostgreSQL, LaTeX, Large Language Model training, SLURM high performance computing workflow
- Languages: Fluent in English, Taiwanese, and Taiwanese Mandarin
- Interests: Economics of Inequality, Labor Economics

SERVICES

- Director of Event Planning, MSU Council of Graduate Students *May 2025 - Present*
- Social Chair, Department of Economics *August 2023 - Aug 2024*

JOB MARKET PAPER

Discounted Degrees: Employer Frictions and the Misallocation of High-Skilled Immigrants

PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

Elbel, B., Zhou, G. E., Lee, D. C., Chen, W., Day, S. E., Konty, K. J., & Schwartz, A. E. (2022). *Analysis of School-Level Vaccination Rates by Race, Ethnicity, and Geography in New York City.* JAMA network open, 5(9), e2231849-e2231849.

WORKING PAPERS

Chen, Willy and Qiao, Xiao and Zhang, Hanzhe, Over a Century of Economics Research Collaboration (May 21, 2025). Available at SSRN: `https://ssrn.com/abstract=5263564` or `http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5263564`

Toossi, Saied and Schwartz, Amy Ellen and Chen, Willy, The Relationship between Entrée Variety and Student Participation in School Lunch (August 01, 2025). Available at SSRN: `https://ssrn.com/abstract=5378789` or `http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5378789`

Chen, Willy, (Resubmitted to Social Choice and Welfare) Descriptive Units of Heterogeneity: An Axiomatic Approach to Measuring Heterogeneity (July 23, 2024). Available at SSRN: `https://ssrn.com/abstract=4952556` or `http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4952556`

WORK IN PROGRESS

Understanding Immigrant Occupational Mismatch: The Role of Intra-Household Bargaining and Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance (with Elif Dilden)

Talent Reallocation Amid Silicon Valley Tech Layoffs (with Hannah Bae and Xintong Li)

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI *August 2022 – Present*

- ***MSU Sailing Center***
  - *Lead Instructor—Small Boat Sailing—Summer '26*
  - *Assistant Instructor—Small Boat Sailing—Summer '25*
- ***Economics Course Instructor :***
  - EC201—Introduction to Microeconomics—Spartan Early Start Session, Summer '25
- ***Economics Courses Teaching Assistant:***
  - EC251H/EC301—Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall '22, '24, '25; Spring '26)
  - EC812B—PhD Game Theory (Spring '24, '25, '26)
- ***Economics Graduate Research Assistant:***
  - Hanzhe Zhang (Fall '23; Summer '24)

Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY *September 2020 – May 2022*
Research Associate, Center for Policy Research

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL *September 2019 – June 2020*
Teaching Assistant, ECON 100/200/201

REFERENCES

Todd Elder (Dissertation Co-Chair) telder@msu.edu
Title: MSU Foundation Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Hanzhe Zhang (Dissertation Co-Chair) hanzhe@msu.edu
Title: Mark A. Simon Distinguished Associate Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Stephen Woodbury (Dissertation Committee Member) woodbur2@msu.edu
Title: Professor of Economics, Michigan State University